

NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy

NCIE TRANSPARENCY & PUBLIC DISCLOSURE POLICY

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Transparency, Public Information, Disclosure, Accountability & Responsible Communication

–

1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy** establishes the principles and procedures through which the **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)** communicates institutional, programme, partnership, financial and operational information to students, educational institutions, Government and public-sector stakeholders, industry partners, CSR organisations, innovators, entrepreneurs, beneficiaries and the general public.

The policy is intended to promote **transparency, accountability, accuracy, responsible communication and public confidence** while protecting confidential, personal, commercially sensitive and legally protected information.

NCIE shall seek to ensure that information published through its official website, programme documents, notices, reports and other authorised communication channels is **accurate, appropriately classified and supported by relevant documentation**.

–

2. POLICY OBJECTIVES

The policy aims to:

- Promote institutional transparency.
- Provide accessible and meaningful public information.
- Improve accountability in programme implementation.
- Clearly communicate NCIE's programmes and activities.
- Distinguish approved information from proposals and planned initiatives.

- Promote responsible disclosure of funding and partnership information.
 - Provide appropriate information regarding institutional collaborations.
 - Support public understanding of programme eligibility and processes.
 - Protect confidential and personal information.
 - Establish a consistent public communication framework.
 - Reduce the possibility of misleading or unverified representations.
-

3. SCOPE OF THE POLICY

This policy applies to information published or communicated through:

- NCIE official website
 - Programme pages
 - Institutional documents
 - Annual reports
 - Programme reports
 - Public notices
 - Press releases
 - Official announcements
 - Social-media communication
 - Brochures and publications
 - Institutional presentations
 - Partnership communications
 - Public programme documentation
-

4. TRANSPARENCY PRINCIPLES

NCIE's public disclosures shall be guided by the following principles:

Accuracy

Information should be factually accurate and appropriately verified before publication.

Clarity

Information should be presented in language that beneficiaries and stakeholders can reasonably understand.

Timeliness

Important programme updates should be published within an appropriate timeframe.

Accountability

Public statements concerning programmes, partnerships, funding or institutional activities should be traceable to appropriate records.

Consistency

The same programme or institutional information should not be represented differently across official communication channels without an appropriate explanation or update.

Responsible Disclosure

Only information appropriate for public disclosure should be published.

Privacy

Personal and sensitive information of beneficiaries, employees, partners and other individuals should be appropriately protected.

—

5. OFFICIAL INFORMATION CATEGORIES

NCIE may publicly disclose appropriate information under the following categories:

A. Institutional Information

- Institutional profile
- Vision and mission
- Objectives
- Organisational structure
- Governance framework
- Programme framework

- Institutional policies
- Official contact information

B. Programme Information

- Programme objectives
- Programme descriptions
- Eligibility
- Duration
- Delivery model
- Curriculum
- Registration process
- Programme fees, where applicable
- Certification criteria
- Important dates

C. Partnership Information

Where authorised and appropriately documented:

- Collaboration announcements
- Institutional partnerships
- MoUs
- Programme partnerships
- Industry collaborations
- Academic partnerships
- CSR partnerships
- Government or public-sector engagement

D. Financial & Resource Information

Where appropriate:

- Approved project budgets
- Funding received
- Project expenditure
- Annual financial information
- Funding utilisation information
- CSR-supported projects
- Resource mobilisation information

The level of disclosure shall depend on applicable legal, contractual and

confidentiality requirements.

–

6. OFFICIAL DOCUMENT DISCLOSURE

Where appropriate, NCIE may publish or provide access to:

- Institutional policies
- Programme guidelines
- Annual reports
- Programme reports
- Public notices
- Approved partnership documents
- Programme brochures
- Institutional reports
- Impact reports
- Public financial information
- Relevant certificates or registration documentation where lawful and appropriate

Confidential or sensitive portions of documents may be withheld or redacted where necessary.

–

7. GOVERNMENT & PUBLIC-SECTOR DISCLOSURE

Any reference to a **Government Ministry, Department, public authority or Government-supported programme** shall accurately describe the nature of the relationship.

NCIE shall distinguish between:

Official Collaboration

Supported by an appropriate formal document or authorised communication.

Programme Alignment

A programme is aligned with a Government policy, mission or national priority but is not necessarily operated by the Government.

Funding Facilitation

NCIE assists an eligible institution or project in identifying or pursuing a potential Government funding opportunity.

Funding Approval

Formal approval or sanction has been issued by the relevant authority.

These categories should not be represented interchangeably.

–

8. GOVERNMENT LOGOS & OFFICIAL IDENTIFIERS

Government emblems, logos, seals, official marks and institutional identifiers shall be used only where their use is legally authorised or otherwise permitted.

NCIE shall not use Government branding in a manner that could reasonably create the impression that NCIE itself is a Government department, ministry or statutory authority unless such status is formally established and supported by appropriate documentation.

Where a programme is merely **aligned with a Government initiative**, the communication should clearly state the nature of the alignment.

–

9. FUNDING DISCLOSURE POLICY

NCIE shall clearly distinguish different funding statuses.

Funding Opportunity

A potential funding source has been identified.

Funding Pipeline

A proposal or potential funding opportunity is under consideration or development.

Proposal Submitted

A formal proposal has been submitted to a funding organisation.

Under Evaluation

The proposal is being considered by the relevant organisation.

Approved / Sanctioned

Formal approval or sanction has been received.

Funds Received

The approved funds have actually been received.

Funds Utilised

Funds have been utilised for the approved purpose.

This classification is intended to prevent **proposed or potential funding from being represented as confirmed funding**.

–

10. CSR DISCLOSURE

CSR partnerships and funding shall be publicly represented only to the extent authorised and supported by appropriate documentation.

Where applicable, disclosures may include:

- CSR partner name
- Project name
- Project objectives
- Project period
- Nature of support
- Beneficiary group
- Approved project value, where publicly disclosable
- Implementation status
- Outcomes

Corporate confidential information shall not be disclosed without appropriate authorisation.

–

11. INVESTOR & STARTUP DISCLOSURE

NCIE may disclose information relating to startup ecosystem and investor connectivity where appropriate.

Any statement concerning potential investment shall clearly distinguish:

Investor Interest

from

Investment Discussion

from

Investment Commitment

from

Investment Completed

For example, an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** shall be described as potential ecosystem connectivity or pipeline facilitation and shall not be represented as a guaranteed investment fund or committed capital unless formal documentation supports such a claim.

–

12. STARTUP SUPPORT DISCLOSURE

Where programmes provide indicative startup support such as:

Up to ₹5 Lakh

the public information should clearly state that such support is subject to:

- Eligibility
- Selection
- Evaluation
- Programme guidelines
- Availability of resources
- Approval
- Applicable conditions

Indicative support shall not be represented as an automatic entitlement.

–

13. INSTITUTIONAL FUNDING DISCLOSURE

Where NCIE facilitates eligible colleges and universities in pursuing institutional funding in an indicative range such as:

₹5 Lakh – ₹25 Lakh

the website and programme documents should clearly state that this represents a **potential funding-support or facilitation framework**.

It should not be represented as:

- Guaranteed Government funding
- Guaranteed Ministry funding
- Guaranteed CSR funding
- Automatic institutional grant
- Guaranteed NCIE funding

unless formally approved and supported by appropriate documentation.

–

14. PARTNERSHIP DISCLOSURE

NCIE may publicly announce partnerships only after appropriate internal authorisation and confirmation of the relationship.

Partnership information may include:

- Partner name
- Nature of partnership
- Programme
- Purpose
- Duration
- Responsibilities
- Geographic scope
- Publicly approved outcomes

Where a partnership is under discussion but not formally executed, it

should be described as **proposed, prospective or under discussion**, as appropriate.

–

15. MOUs & COLLABORATION DOCUMENTS

Where legally permissible, NCIE may disclose:

- MoUs
- Collaboration agreements
- Partnership letters
- Institutional collaboration documents
- Project agreements
- Government correspondence
- Sanction letters
- Approval documents

Publication shall depend on:

- Confidentiality clauses
 - Consent of the parties
 - Legal restrictions
 - Commercial sensitivity
 - Data-protection requirements
-

16. PROGRAMME FEE DISCLOSURE

Programme pages should clearly communicate:

- Registration fee
- Programme fee
- Payment conditions
- Refund policy where applicable
- Eligibility
- Duration
- Delivery mode
- Certification conditions

For example, where a programme has a **₹700 participation fee**, the

website should clearly state what the fee covers and whether any additional charges apply.

–

17. SCHOLARSHIP & BENEFICIARY DISCLOSURE

Public communication concerning scholarships and beneficiary programmes should provide appropriate information regarding:

- Eligibility
- Selection criteria
- Application process
- Important dates
- Scholarship amount where applicable
- Selection process
- Documentation requirements

Personal information of beneficiaries should not be publicly disclosed without appropriate consent or lawful basis.

–

18. PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION

NCIE shall seek to protect personal information including, where applicable:

- Names
- Contact details
- Identification information
- Bank information
- Academic records
- Photographs
- Addresses
- Personal documents

Personal data shall be disclosed only where necessary, authorised and legally permissible.

–

19. CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

The following categories may require restricted access:

- Personal information
 - Bank details
 - Confidential contracts
 - Commercially sensitive information
 - Proprietary technology
 - Unpublished research
 - Internal assessments
 - Confidential Government correspondence
 - Investor due-diligence information
 - Sensitive employee information
 - Security-related information
-

20. PUBLIC DISCLOSURE REGISTER

NCIE may maintain a public disclosure register containing appropriate records such as:

Category	Disclosure
Institutional	Institutional profile and policies
Programmes	Programme descriptions and guidelines
Partnerships	Confirmed public partnerships
Government	Documented engagements
CSR	Authorised CSR projects
Reports	Annual / programme reports
Finance	Publicly disclosable financial information
Impact	Programme outcomes and impact

Notices Official announcements

—

21. WEBSITE DISCLOSURE STRUCTURE

The NCIE website may provide dedicated sections for:

About NCIE

Institutional profile and organisational information.

Programmes

Programme descriptions, eligibility and participation information.

Government & Institutional Engagement

Documented collaborations and institutional engagements.

Partnerships

Academic, industry, CSR and ecosystem partnerships.

Reports & Publications

Annual reports, programme reports and public documents.

Financial & Funding Information

Appropriate public financial and funding information.

Policies

Institutional policies and guidelines.

Notices & Announcements

Official programme and institutional updates.

Contact & Grievance

Official communication and grievance channels.

—

22. PUBLIC DISCLOSURE REVIEW PROCESS

Before publication of significant institutional information:

INFORMATION PREPARATION



DOCUMENT VERIFICATION



PROGRAMME / DEPARTMENT REVIEW



LEGAL / COMPLIANCE REVIEW WHERE REQUIRED



AUTHORISATION



PUBLICATION



PERIODIC REVIEW

—

23. CONTENT VERIFICATION

Information should be reviewed for:

- Accuracy
- Source documentation
- Dates
- Names
- Funding status
- Partnership status
- Financial figures
- Programme eligibility
- Legal terminology

- Government references
 - Contact information
-

24. CORRECTION & UPDATE POLICY

Where materially incorrect information is identified, NCIE should:

1. Review the information.
2. Verify the correct position.
3. Correct the publication.
4. Record the correction where appropriate.
5. Update related documents if necessary.

Material corrections should not be concealed where transparency requires acknowledgement.

–

25. VERSION CONTROL

Important public documents may include:

- Document title
- Version number
- Effective date
- Publication date
- Revision date
- Issuing authority

This enables stakeholders to identify the current version of a document.

–

26. PUBLIC NOTICE & ANNOUNCEMENT POLICY

Official announcements should, where applicable, contain:

- Announcement title
- Date
- Programme / subject
- Relevant details

- Effective date
- Contact information
- Issuing authority

Announcements should not contain unsupported claims.

–

27. SOCIAL MEDIA DISCLOSURE

NCIE's social-media communication should follow the same principles applicable to official website communication.

Social-media posts should not:

- Misrepresent Government affiliation.
- Claim unapproved funding as sanctioned.
- Present potential investment as guaranteed.
- Publish confidential information.
- Publish personal information without appropriate permission.
- Make unsupported claims concerning beneficiaries or outcomes.

–

28. MEDIA & PRESS COMMUNICATION

Press releases and public statements should be issued through authorised channels.

Major claims regarding:

- Government collaboration
- Funding
- CSR support
- Institutional partnerships
- Startup investment
- Programme achievements

should be supported by appropriate records.

–

29. ANNUAL TRANSPARENCY REPORT

Where appropriate, NCIE may publish an annual transparency or institutional report covering:

- Programmes implemented
 - Beneficiary reach
 - Institutional partnerships
 - Government / public-sector engagements
 - CSR-supported initiatives
 - Resource mobilisation
 - Programme outcomes
 - Impact highlights
 - Financial information where appropriate
 - Major institutional developments
-

30. DISCLOSURE OF PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

Programme performance may be reported through:

- Participation statistics
- Completion rates
- Training outputs
- Innovation projects
- Startup progression
- Institutional outcomes
- Partnership activities
- Impact indicators

Published statistics should be based on available records and should clearly identify the relevant reporting period.

—

31. PUBLIC ACCESS TO INFORMATION

NCIE shall seek to make relevant institutional and programme information reasonably accessible through its official communication channels.

Public information may include:

- Programme guidelines

- Eligibility
- Registration process
- Contact information
- Policies
- Notices
- Reports
- Confirmed partnerships
- Public institutional documents

Access may be restricted where information is confidential, legally protected or otherwise inappropriate for public disclosure.

—

32. GRIEVANCE & FEEDBACK

Stakeholders may be provided with channels to raise:

- Incorrect information concerns
- Programme-related complaints
- Registration issues
- Certification issues
- Partnership-related concerns
- Disclosure concerns
- Other institutional feedback

Complaints should be recorded and addressed through the appropriate internal mechanism.

—

33. ACCOUNTABILITY FOR PUBLIC INFORMATION

Responsibility for public disclosures may be distributed across:

AUTHORISED NCIE MANAGEMENT

↓

COMMUNICATION / DOCUMENTATION FUNCTION

↓

PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT



FINANCE / ADMINISTRATION



LEGAL / COMPLIANCE REVIEW WHERE REQUIRED



OFFICIAL PUBLICATION CHANNEL

No unauthorised individual should represent personal statements as official NCIE institutional positions.

—

34. TRANSPARENCY IN PROGRAMME CLAIMS

NCIE shall seek to use precise terminology such as:

- **“Implemented”** only where implementation has occurred.
- **“Approved”** where formal approval exists.
- **“Proposed”** for proposals.
- **“Planned”** for future activities.
- **“Facilitated”** where NCIE provides facilitation.
- **“Aligned with”** where a programme is aligned with a policy or national priority.
- **“In partnership with”** where a formal partnership exists.
- **“Potential”** for opportunities that are not confirmed.
- **“Indicative”** for planning or pipeline figures.

—

35. PROHIBITED OR RESTRICTED REPRESENTATIONS

NCIE public communications should not knowingly:

- Claim Government status without legal basis.
- Claim statutory authority without supporting documentation.
- Represent a proposed programme as an officially sanctioned

Government programme.

- Represent potential funding as confirmed funding.
- Represent investor pipeline figures as committed capital.
- Represent prospective partnerships as executed partnerships.
- Publish fabricated statistics.
- Misrepresent beneficiary outcomes.
- Use Government insignia without appropriate authority.
- Publish confidential information.
- Make guarantees that are not supported by programme terms.

—

36. TRANSPARENCY & FUNDING STATUS MODEL

IDENTIFIED

Potential opportunity identified.

↓

PROPOSED

Project or funding concept developed.

↓

SUBMITTED

Proposal submitted.

↓

UNDER REVIEW

Proposal under evaluation.

↓

APPROVED

Formal approval received.

↓

SANCTIONED

Formal sanction / agreement received.



RECEIVED

Resources received.



UTILISED

Resources utilised for the approved purpose.

This model should be used consistently in public funding communications.

—

37. PARTNERSHIP STATUS MODEL

DISCUSSION

Initial engagement.



PROPOSED

Partnership concept under development.



NEGOTIATION

Terms under discussion.



EXECUTED

Formal agreement completed.



ACTIVE

Partnership being implemented.



COMPLETED

Agreed activities completed.

—

38. DISCLOSURE & COMPLIANCE REVIEW

NCIE may periodically review its public information for:

- Accuracy
- Completeness
- Outdated information
- Government references
- Partnership claims
- Funding claims
- Programme information
- Legal notices
- Privacy compliance

—

39. RECORD RETENTION

Supporting records for significant public disclosures should be retained for an appropriate period in accordance with:

- Applicable law
- Funding requirements
- Partnership agreements
- Organisational policies
- Financial requirements
- Documentation requirements

—

40. TRANSPARENCY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

NCIE may monitor:

- Number of public reports published
 - Programme information updated
 - Partnership disclosures completed
 - Funding-status updates
 - Financial reporting completion
 - Grievances received
 - Grievances resolved
 - Public information corrections
 - Website document updates
 - Annual disclosure completion
-

41. POLICY REVIEW

This policy should be reviewed periodically to reflect:

- Changes in applicable law
 - Regulatory developments
 - Organisational changes
 - New programme requirements
 - Funding-partner requirements
 - Data-protection requirements
 - Lessons from implementation
-

42. OVERALL TRANSPARENCY MODEL

NCIE's public disclosure framework follows:

VERIFY



CLASSIFY



AUTHORISE



DISCLOSE



MONITOR



UPDATE



CORRECT



REPORT

—

43. POLICY STATEMENT

NCIE is committed to maintaining a transparent, accountable and responsible public-information system through which stakeholders can access appropriate information concerning its institutional profile, programmes, partnerships, funding frameworks, activities, outcomes and policies.

NCIE shall seek to distinguish clearly between confirmed information, approved activities, proposed initiatives, funding opportunities, facilitation activities, investment pipelines and future plans.

All public disclosures shall be subject to appropriate verification, authorisation, confidentiality requirements, privacy considerations and applicable legal and regulatory obligations.

—

44. FINAL TRANSPARENCY COMMITMENT

ACCURATE INFORMATION

DOCUMENTED CLAIMS

CLEAR FUNDING STATUS

RESPONSIBLE GOVERNMENT REFERENCES

AUTHORISED PARTNERSHIP DISCLOSURE

PROTECTED PERSONAL INFORMATION

ACCOUNTABLE REPORTING

CONTINUOUS UPDATES

The NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy is intended to strengthen public confidence by ensuring that institutional information is communicated accurately, funding and partnership claims are appropriately qualified, programme achievements are supported by evidence, and confidential or personal information is protected.